



LEADERSHIP FOR THE 21ST CENTURY

There are lots of things that can be done in transportation. Every country could become virtually energy independent in transportation. So, if I were, for example, in charge of this in India, I would be trying to modernise the rail system, I would be trying to accelerate the production of the natural gas-powered vehicles that are now regularly used around the Taj Mahal to reduce local air pollution there. I would be looking for all kinds of other things that can be done. We are very close to developing a car which goes up to a hundred miles to a gallon, in America, with a Lithium battery that will run on electricity for up to 55 miles an hour and then kick over into fuel. And our foundation is working in all these areas, but especially in the buildings areas, where a non-governmental organisation can have a great impact. You simply organise people to finance these improvements out of lower electricity bills and we can create millions of jobs on every continent. I think that India with its heritage, its rich and deep heritage of non-governmental organisations, may be in the best position to devise localised solutions to a lot of these problems with an even bigger and even better funded non-governmental movement.

But, this is a very exciting world that we are living in. There are more people generating more wealth and more opportunities than ever before. But those of us, who have it,

have a huge responsibility to plough some of it back into the future so that all our children can enjoy these benefits. We are still a long way from the world of shared benefits, shared opportunities and shared responsibilities.

The progress, to me, is immensely obviously encouraging. I am far more optimistic than pessimistic. But I don't think we could deny the searing impacts of inequality and what it does to diminish the potential of a country like India. I don't think we can deny that a troubling insecurity still exists in the world because of the conflicts that you see most pronounced in the Middle East and are everywhere else in the world in every continent.

So this is an exciting time to be alive, there is plenty to do every morning to keep us busy, to keep us worried, but also to keep us hopeful. On balance I am quite optimistic about the future but, also, we have to deal with these big challenges and we can't expect the government to do it all as there is simply not the capacity to do it nor the political support to do it. But ironically, it has been my experience in all these countries where I am working, that the more the non-governmental sector does, the more we prove that these problems can be solved, the better government policies we get. These two things work hand-in-hand. And that is one of the reasons why I am quite hopeful about the future.

"THE ANSWER TO CONCERNS ABOUT OUTSOURCING IS TO GIVE AMERICANS AN ALTERNATIVE FUTURE THAT GENERATES JOBS."

Bill Clinton

D I S C U S S I O N

Q. What are the issues in the American presidential elections that you think would lead to somebody winning it?

Clinton: Today, the issue is how to bring back the American economy, and how to restore America's standing as a major force for peace as well as security. After I left office, we withdrew from the Comprehensive Test Ban Treaty, from the International Criminal Court and from the Kyoto accord on climate change. So many people in the world began to think that America wanted one set of rules for itself and another set for the rest of the world. I think what we have to do is to re-establish that we want to cooperate with other countries and not to act alone.

Q. What one hears amidst the American election is a lot of voices on protectionism. What will be the stand on outsourcing,

in case a Democrat becomes the president?

Clinton: The answer is to give Americans an alternative future that actually generates jobs and income. We went back to what I think are more selfish and short-sighted policies. We have virtually no trade enforcement anymore. As far as I know, no candidate has claimed that anyone should be prohibited from doing whatever they wanted with their own property and wealth. But there are a couple of provisions in the US tax code that actually make it more attractive in some cases to move jobs offshore. But there have been calls to make sure that the tax code is neutral on this subject and not actually pro-outsourcing.

Q. What is your view on the nuclear deal? Is it good for India? Would we get the same deal from a Democratic president?

Clinton: I think that the deepening cooperation between our two countries is good. There was a lot of concern in the US about whether it went far enough on non-proliferation. But I think in general when new governments come in, even if there is a change of parties; they tend to honour the agreements by the previous administration.

In the Democratic Party, there is an enormous amount of support for rapprochement between our two countries and, as in my term, it has continued under the Bush administration. It is one area where our policies have been consistent.

Q. Was the war on Iraq necessary? Do you think when the next administration comes, the American troops will go back home safe and sound?

Clinton: Well, first of all, I believe that it was a mistake to

attack Iraq before the UN weapons inspectors finished their job because not one WMD (weapon of mass destruction) was found. But, in general, I can tell you what Hillary said. She said if she is elected and the situation is as it is now, she will ask the Joint Chiefs of Staff to begin the process of bringing back the US troops in the first 60 days.

Q. If Hillary Clinton becomes president you will of course become the first spouse. How are you looking forward to that role and what will that role be?

Clinton: Well, if she is elected, I'll do whatever I am asked to do. I would hope that I could be helpful to her just in giving advice, thinking through these problems and in dealing with the issues.

Full speech and debate at:

<http://www.indiatodayconclave.com>